Google Play Launch Guide

Five Android apps: ETEL Delivery, Ride, Drive, Courier and Service

Where things stand. The website and code fixes are finished and merged. What remains is: rebuild four apps (Driver, Courier, Service and Ride) in PWABuilder, test on a real phone, and upload to Google Play. This guide has every setting you need.

1. What is already done

Item	Status	Where
Digital Asset Links file (links each app to ethelmarket.com)	Done, merged	ethelmarket.com/.well-known/assetlinks.json
Delete-account panel inside Driver, Courier, Service, Ride	Done, merged	Profile or Settings menu
Public account deletion page	Done, merged	ethelmarket.com/delivery/delete-account.html
Updated privacy policy (permissions, services, deletion)	Done, merged	ethelmarket.com/delivery/privacy.html
Working Privacy and Terms links in the apps	Done, merged	Customer and Service apps
Store listing text, English and Amharic	Written	docs/play-store-listings.md and -am.md
Automatic deploy zips on every merge	Done, merged	GitHub Releases

2. What you still have to do

1. **Deploy and check.** Upload the deploy zips, then open the three live URLs below in a browser.
2. **Rebuild in PWABuilder** Driver, Courier, Service and Ride with the settings in section 4. Use your existing keystore.
3. **Test on a real Android phone.** Use the checklist in section 6.
4. **Create the apps in Play Console** and fill in the policy forms (section 7).
5. **Upload the .aab file** to Internal testing, then run the closed test, then go to Production.
6. **Process deletion requests.** Someone must read the support messages and delete accounts within 5 business days.

Check these 3 links open correctly after you deploy:
1. https://ethelmarket.com/.well-known/assetlinks.json (must load directly, no redirect)
2. https://ethelmarket.com/delivery/delete-account.html
3. https://ethelmarket.com/delivery/privacy.html (has a section called "Deleting Your Account")

3. Why the apps must be rebuilt

The first packages you built have two problems that cannot be fixed on the website. They are baked into the Android file itself.

- **Driver, Courier and Service open the wrong page.** All three launch ethelmarket.com/delivery/ instead of their own screen. Google rejects apps that look like duplicates.
- **Notifications are switched off in four of five packages.** Only Delivery has the permission. Driver, Courier, Ride and Service need it for ride, job and order alerts.

> **Delivery does not need a rebuild.** Its start page is the customer app and it already has notification permission. Rebuild it only if you want a new version number.

4. PWABuilder settings for each app

Go to **pwabuilder.com**, enter the Manifest URL, then **Package for stores > Android > Google Play > Options**. Labels can change slightly; match by meaning.

Setting	Driver	Courier	Service	Ride
Manifest URL	ethelmarket.com/delivery/manifest-driver.json	ethelmarket.com/delivery/manifest-courier.json	ethelmarket.com/delivery/manifest-service.json	ethelmarket.com/delivery/manifest-ride.json
Package ID	com.etel.driver	com.etel.courier	com.etel.service	com.etel.ride
App name	ETEL Drive - Hawassa	ETEL Courier - Hawassa	ETEL Service - Hawassa	ETEL Ride
Host	ethelmarket.com	ethelmarket.com	ethelmarket.com	ethelmarket.com
Start URL	/delivery/driver/?source=pwa	/delivery/courier/?source=pwa	/delivery/servicegiver.html?source=pwa	/delivery/ride/?source=pwa
Theme color	#007AFF	#D4AF37	#D4AF37	#D4AF37
Background	#0a1428	#0a0703	#0a0703	#0B0B12
Display / Orientation	Standalone / Portrait	Standalone / Portrait	Standalone / Portrait	Standalone / Portrait

Same for all four apps:

Setting	Value
Icon and maskable icon	The app's own icons, e.g. ethelmarket.com/delivery/icons/driver-icon-512.png and driver-icon-512-maskable.png (use courier-, service- or ride- for the others)
Notification delegation	ON (all four apps)
Location delegation	ON (Driver, Courier and Ride)
Google Play Billing	OFF (you sell physical goods and services)
Fallback behavior	Custom Tabs (default)

5. Signing key

In the signing options choose **Use mine** and upload your **signing.keystore** from the first build.

- **Key alias:** etel-apps. **Passwords:** in signing-key-info.txt. Keep these private. Never email them or put them in the repository.
- Using the same keystore keeps the fingerprint the same, so the assetlinks.json you deployed stays valid.
- A new key means a new fingerprint. You would have to add it to assetlinks.json or the address bar will show in the app.
- If you already uploaded version 1 to Play, the rebuild needs a higher version code (for example 2).

Use Play App Signing. Google holds the real signing key and your keystore becomes only the upload key. After the first upload, open Play Console > Setup > App signing, copy the **Google SHA-256 fingerprint** and add it to assetlinks.json as well. Users install the Google-signed build, so without it the address bar will appear.

6. Test on a real phone (every app)

Click **Generate**, download the zip. It contains an **.aab** (upload to Play) and an **.apk** (install on the phone to test).

Check	Pass when
Opens its own screen	Driver shows driver app, Courier shows courier app, and so on (not the delivery landing page)
No address bar	Full-screen app. If a bar shows, the asset link failed: check the fingerprint and the assetlinks URL
Push notification	Trigger a ride request, job or order with the app closed. The alert arrives
Location	Driver, Courier and Ride show the right position
Bluetooth printer	Driver prints a receipt
Delete my account	The panel opens and sends the request (Driver, Courier, Service, Ride)
Privacy Policy link	Opens the policy page

Known limit: Driver and Courier location only updates while the app is on screen. If the phone locks or the driver switches apps, tracking pauses. Tell drivers to keep the app open. Do not promise background tracking in the store listing.

7. Upload to Google Play

Do this once for each of the five apps in **Play Console > Create app** (App, Free).

Section	What to enter
Privacy policy	https://ethelmarket.com/delivery/privacy.html
Account deletion URL	https://ethelmarket.com/delivery/delete-account.html
App access	Test accounts for Driver, Courier and Service (reviewers cannot get in otherwise)
Ads	No
Target audience	18 and over
Content rating	Answer the questionnaire honestly. Likely "Everyone"
Data safety	Location, name, phone, address, payment info; drivers and couriers also selfie and licence photo. Encrypted in transit: yes. Account deletion: yes
Store listing	Paste text from the listing files. Add 512px icon, 1024x500 feature graphic, 2+ phone screenshots
Categories	Delivery: Food and Drink. Ride and Drive: Maps and Navigation. Courier and Service: Business

Release path

1. **Internal testing:** upload the .aab, add yourself and a few drivers as testers, start rollout.
2. **Closed testing:** a new personal developer account must run 12 or more testers for 14 days before production. An organization account usually does not.
3. **Production:** when testers confirm everything works, promote the release.

Other stores

The same .apk can go to Samsung Galaxy Store, Huawei AppGallery, Amazon Appstore and Xiaomi GetApps. Huawei phones have no Google services, so test notifications and maps there first. Apple's App Store needs a different (non-TWA) build and is not covered here.

8. Before you go live

- **Process deletion requests.** They arrive as support messages. The policy promises a reply within 5 business days.
- **Check the older policy claims.** The policy says chat is deleted within 24 hours and location is kept at most 30 days. Make sure the system really does this, or edit the policy.
- **Fill in support contact.** Replace the [support email / phone] placeholders in every listing.
- **Have an Amharic speaker review** the Amharic listings before you use them.
- **Do not publish the Admin app.** Keep it web-only.

This guide was prepared from the project repository. Steps in PWABuilder and Play Console were not run from the development environment, and screen labels can differ slightly.